



A LIVE CAPABILITY POSITION READ

Should I Stay or Should I Move?

Read what your current work is building before you decide.

Bring the last ninety days of your actual working life. Every score in this workbook is made against that window and nothing else.

YOUR NAME

DATE

Temidayo Afonja

Founder, The Density Group. Author, The Capability Audit.

CAPABILITY FORMATION INSTRUMENT VERSION 1.1 · WORKBOOK V5.8 · FILLABLE

This is a fillable document. Enter your responses directly into the fields and save a copy when complete.

For automatic totals, open this workbook in Adobe Acrobat Reader on a laptop or desktop. In some browser and mobile viewers, the fields remain typeable, but automatic calculations may not run.



Before you start

Read this page while people are arriving.



This session will not tell you to stay or leave. It will help you read what your current environment is building in you, what remains portable, and what category of move your evidence supports testing.

What you score today is a position you occupy, and positions change.

HOW THE TWO-HOUR SESSION WORKS

1 Initial read

You score all twelve statements as you read them today. No evidence required yet. This is your uncalibrated baseline.

2 Calibration

The evidence protocol, the three ways capable people misread their own position, and the correction map.

3 Evidence-backed read

You score all twelve again, this time with evidence in both directions. You keep the first number.

4 Decide

Re-total, place yourself again, and write your Next-Move Decision.

Your first score is not a test you can fail. It is the reading you would have carried into a decision this week, and it is worth capturing before anything corrects it.

A NOTE ON THIS SESSION

This is a founding pilot, and you are helping refine the delivery and evidence process. The instrument itself is frozen at Version 1.1 and is not being changed by this room. Room-level totals are recorded without names, individual scores, or identifiable responses. Nothing you write in this workbook is collected. Thirty days from now you will get one short set of questions about what actually happened, and answering it is optional.

This read informs a career decision. It does not replace financial, legal, medical, immigration, contractual, or family judgment.



SECTION 1

Your initial read

Twelve statements, scored against the last ninety days you actually lived. No evidence yet, and that is deliberate.



Your initial read

Density. Learning velocity, whether this environment is still forming you.



Score 1 strongly disagree to 5 strongly agree, against the last ninety days you actually lived. Type a number in each box. No evidence line yet, and that is deliberate.

- | | | |
|----------|---|---|
| 1 | In the last ninety days I have been handed a problem I did not already know how to solve. | 1 - 5 <input style="width: 50px;" type="text"/> |
| 2 | I work close enough to people who are better than me that I can watch how they think. | 1 - 5 <input style="width: 50px;" type="text"/> |
| 3 | My work is reviewed by someone who can tell the difference between good and adequate, and who says so directly. | 1 - 5 <input style="width: 50px;" type="text"/> |
| 4 | The feedback I receive changes what I do next, not just how I feel. | 1 - 5 <input style="width: 50px;" type="text"/> |
| 5 | I regularly operate at the edge of my competence rather than the comfortable center of it. | 1 - 5 <input style="width: 50px;" type="text"/> |
| 6 | Looking back six months, the work I do now would have been genuinely hard for me then. | 1 - 5 <input style="width: 50px;" type="text"/> |

Add the six answers. Density, initial (out of 30):

19 to 30 is high on this axis. 6 to 18 is low.

Any score between 17 and 21 is a boundary, even a high one.



Your initial read

Optionality. Market portability, whether what you built is yours to carry.



Score 1 strongly disagree to 5 strongly agree, against the last ninety days you actually lived. Type a number in each box. No evidence line yet, and that is deliberate.

- 7 The capability I am building would be valued by an employer in a different industry. 1 - 5
- 8 I can describe what I do in terms of outcomes, not just my company's internal language. 1 - 5
- 9 If my role disappeared tomorrow, the capability I built would still be mine to carry. 1 - 5
- 10 People with the power to hire or advance me, inside or outside my company, can already see what I am good at. 1 - 5
- 11 What I am learning is a transferable capability rather than a company-specific procedure. 1 - 5
- 12 I could rebuild a strong position somewhere else within a year. 1 - 5

Add the six answers. Optionality, initial (out of 30):

19 to 30 is high on this axis. 6 to 18 is low.

Any score between 17 and 21 is a boundary, even a high one.



Read this before you go further

Four distinctions. Each one changes how the square should be read.



Performance and formation are different readings

Performance measures what you delivered for somebody else. Formation measures what the work is doing to you. Strong reviews and flat formation are routine companions.

State is not identity

A current condition rather than a personality type or a permanent address. People move between squares.

A low Optionality score is not a verdict

It may reflect context-bound capability, weak translation, limited exposure, or a combination. It is not a verdict on your ability or worth.

Your first score is not wrong

It is uncalibrated. Those are different things, and the uncalibrated read is what everybody carries into a decision until something corrects it.

This is not a performance rating, a potential rating, or a nine-box grid. It reads your conditions, not your worth to an employer.



First placement

Your initial read, placed. The position you were carrying when you walked in.



DENSITY, INITIAL

/ 30

OPTIONALITY, INITIAL

/ 30

DENSITY: HIGH AT TOP, LOW AT BOTTOM

DEPTH TRAP Deep expertise fused to one context.	COMPOUNDING Deep capability that travels.
STAGNANT The work stopped asking more of you.	FRAGILE Options on paper, not enough depth beneath.

OPTIONALITY: LOW AT LEFT TO HIGH AT RIGHT

TICK YOUR SQUARE ABOVE, THEN COMPLETE THESE

MY INITIAL STATE

CONFIDENCE IN THAT PLACEMENT, 1 TO 5

19 to 30 is high on an axis. 6 to 18 is low. Any score between 17 and 21 is a boundary, even a high one, and you read both neighbouring states. Hold this placement lightly: you will do it again, on different numbers, in about forty minutes.



SECTION 2

Calibration

The evidence protocol, the ways capable people misread their own position, and what has to change before you score again.



Every corrected score requires an evidence line from the last ninety days. Every score, in both directions.

A 4 or 5

At least one clear positive instance from within the window.

A 3

The mixed or inconsistent pattern. A 3 is a reading, not an absence of one.

A 1 or 2

What repeatedly happened instead, a relevant counterexample, or a statement that no qualifying instance occurred across the window.

WHEN YOU CANNOT SUPPORT IT EITHER WAY

Write your most defensible number and put a question mark after it: 3?, 4?, 2?. Do not force the number downward and do not default to a 3. A 3 means mixed. A question mark means unsupported. Those are different findings.

One or two marked items on an axis

The axis and your placement are provisional. You will run a quick check on the next round to see whether the uncertainty changes anything.

Three or more on one axis

That axis is incomplete and you will not place on it. That is a finding about what the last ninety days contained, not a low score.

A score without an evidence line is a guess with decimal points.



What has to change before you score again

Tick the ones you recognise in your own scoring.



ENTERING BELIEF

☐

"The work is demanding, so I must be growing."

EXITING BELIEF

"A demanding role can stop forming me and still feel full."

☐

"I would have options if I decided to look."

"Options depend on whether people outside can already see what I am good at."

☐

"This is what my role gives me."

"I scored the ninety days I actually lived."

☐

"They rely on me here."

"Being needed and being formed are separate conditions."

☐

"A low score means I am not good enough."

"A low Optionality score may be about translation or exposure, not ability."

Now score all twelve again, on the next four pages. Do not look back at your first numbers while you do it, and do not change them. The pair is the finding.



SECTION 3

Evidence-backed read

Score all twelve again, this time with evidence in both directions. You keep the first number.



Evidence-backed read

Density, statements 1 to 3.



CORRECTED

- 1 In the last ninety days I have been handed a problem I did not already know how to solve.

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

CORRECTED

- 2 I work close enough to people who are better than me that I can watch how they think.

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

CORRECTED

- 3 My work is reviewed by someone who can tell the difference between good and adequate, and who says so directly.

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

Evidence in both directions. If you cannot support it either way, write the number and add a question mark.



Evidence-backed read

Density, statements 4 to 6.



4 The feedback I receive changes what I do next, not just how I feel.

CORRECTED

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

5 I regularly operate at the edge of my competence rather than the comfortable center of it.

CORRECTED

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

6 Looking back six months, the work I do now would have been genuinely hard for me then.

CORRECTED

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

Evidence in both directions. If you cannot support it either way, write the number and add a question mark.



Evidence-backed read

Optionality, statements 7 to 9.



7

The capability I am building would be valued by an employer in a different industry.

CORRECTED

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

8

I can describe what I do in terms of outcomes, not just my company's internal language.

CORRECTED

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

9

If my role disappeared tomorrow, the capability I built would still be mine to carry.

CORRECTED

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

Evidence in both directions. If you cannot support it either way, write the number and add a question mark.



Evidence-backed read

Optionality, statements 10 to 12.



- I0** People with the power to hire or advance me, inside or outside my company, can already see what I am good at.

CORRECTED

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

- II** What I am learning is a transferable capability rather than a company-specific procedure.

CORRECTED

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

- I2** I could rebuild a strong position somewhere else within a year.

CORRECTED

EVIDENCE FROM THE LAST NINETY DAYS

Evidence in both directions. If you cannot support it either way, write the number and add a question mark.



Re-total and place again

New numbers. A fresh placement, not a review of the first one.



DENSITY, CORRECTED (AUTO)

/ 30

OPTIONALITY, CORRECTED (AUTO)

/ 30

NEIGHBOURING-SCORE SENSITIVITY CHECK: RUN THIS IF AN AXIS CARRIES ONE OR TWO QUESTION MARKS

- 1 Total the axis using the numbers exactly as you wrote them.
- 2 Total it again with every marked item one point lower.
- 3 Total it again with every marked item one point higher.
- 4 If all three totals stay on the same side of 19, and none lands between 17 and 21, place yourself and mark the placement provisional.
- 5 If they do not, do not pick one square. Read both neighbouring states.

DENSITY: HIGH AT TOP, LOW AT BOTTOM

☐ DEPTH TRAP Deep expertise fused to one context.	☐ COMPOUNDING Deep capability that travels.
☐ STAGNANT The work stopped asking more of you.	☐ FRAGILE Options on paper, not enough depth beneath.

OPTIONALITY: LOW AT LEFT TO HIGH AT RIGHT

MY CORRECTED STATE

CORRECTED CONFIDENCE, 1 TO 5

DATE OF THIS READ

Three or more marked items on one axis: that axis is incomplete and you do not place on it today. It means the last ninety days did not contain enough evidence to read that axis, usually a period of leave, a transition, or a role you had only just started. That is worth knowing before you make a decision on it.

NEIGHBOURING-SCORE SENSITIVITY CHECK

Keep every neighbouring score within the 1 to 5 response scale. A 1? is never tested at 0 and a 5? is never tested at 6. The neighbouring-score sensitivity check is an operational pilot convention, not a statistical confidence interval: where plausible neighbouring values change the placement, or touch the boundary band of 17 to 21, no single state is assigned.



What moved

Both readings side by side. Fill this in immediately after your second placement.



	INITIAL	CORRECTED
Density		
Optionality		
State		
Confidence		

THE STATEMENT I OVERRATED, AND THE EVIDENCE I COULD NOT NAME

THE STATEMENT I UNDERRATED, AND WHY I SCORED IT LOW

THE ITEMS I MARKED WITH A QUESTION MARK, AND WHAT THAT TELLS ME ABOUT THE WINDOW

You are comparing your first and corrected readings and examining what, if anything, moved. Nothing about your working life changed while you were scoring. Only the reading did.

A self-score cannot tell you whether you scored yourself accurately. That is a property of self-assessment rather than a flaw in you.



SECTION 4

Decide

Re-total, place yourself again, and write the Next-Move Decision you leave with.



What each state costs

A short reference. Read your own square before you write the next page.



DEPTH TRAP

IMMEDIATE COST

Value legible inside one building, close to illegible outside it.

FALSE REASSURANCE

"They could never replace me here."

COMPOUNDING

IMMEDIATE COST

Maintaining both axes requires continued renewal. A strong current position can make early slippage easy to miss.

FALSE REASSURANCE

"I am doing well, so this square has nothing to tell me."

STAGNANT

IMMEDIATE COST

The clock is running and nothing is accruing on either axis.

FALSE REASSURANCE

"I am well regarded here."

FRAGILE

IMMEDIATE COST

What travels today is no longer being renewed by the work you are doing now.

FALSE REASSURANCE

"I could leave tomorrow."

The Field Kit takes this further through the Standing-Still Worksheet: the learning gap, translation gap, and exposure, with rough numbers where they fit and a worked example. Use it in the next thirty days. This page is the in-session reference, not the whole treatment.

No state is a verdict, and no state prescribes a move.



What my state costs me

Your square. Your words. Not what to do about it, what it takes if nothing changes.



THE IMMEDIATE COST

THE HIDDEN COST

THE COST OF WAITING

THE FALSE REASSURANCE THAT KEEPS ME HERE

WHAT ONE MORE QUARTER IN THIS STATE TAKES FROM ME, IN ONE LINE

Once it has words, standing still stops being background anxiety and becomes a choice you are making.



Seven categories of move

Direction, not a plan. Tick the one your evidence supports.



Remain and deepen

The formation conditions are real and worth protecting.

Translate what is built

The capability exists. The language for it does not.

Widen exposure

The work is good and the wrong people have seen it.

Test portability

Find out what travels before you need it to.

Repair formation conditions

Change the work, not the employer, first.

Prepare for exit

The conditions will not repair, and the clock is running.

Seek an external perspective

The stakes are high, the evidence is incomplete, or your position is near a boundary. Ask someone with sufficient distance and standing to challenge the read.

No square prescribes a category. Your evidence, your decision horizon, your constraints, and your risk tolerance all still apply. Almost every category here needs another person, which is why the next page asks who.



01 My corrected state is

02 The evidence supporting this read is

03 The assumption I corrected today is

04 The immediate and hidden cost of remaining unchanged is

05 The risk of doing nothing for the next ninety days is

06 The category of move my evidence supports testing is

07 The first action I will take, and by when, is

08 The person I will say this to, and by when, is

09 The evidence that would cause me to revise this decision is

10 The date I will rescore is



Thirty-day evidence log

One line a week. The action, and what actually happened.



Line 7 is provisional. Line 9 is what makes it responsible. This page is where you find out which one was right.

WEEK	WHAT I DID	WHAT CHANGED, OR WHAT DID NOT
W ₁		
W ₂		
W ₃		
W ₄		

THE DATE I RESCORE

WHERE I RESCORE

Field Kit, Section 7: the Quarterly Loop

Rescore in ninety days using the evidence process in your Field Kit. Section 7, the Quarterly Loop, is built for exactly this: rescore all twelve, compare statement by statement rather than totals, re-place, and reset the date.

Even in a good quarter. Especially in a good quarter.



Where you go from here

Three things, and they do different jobs. Read the difference before you choose.



I Today's live Capability Position Read

What you just did. Twelve statements read twice, corrected against evidence, placed twice, in a calibrated room.

COMPLETE · THIS WORKBOOK IS THE RECORD

2 The Capability Formation Field Kit

Yours, unlocked today. Section 5 works out what your state costs in your own numbers. Section 7 is your ninety-day rescore, and it is the tool to use: it runs the same evidence process you were taught today.

INCLUDED · UNLOCKED TODAY · YOUR RESCORE TOOL

3 The free Diagnostic

The same twelve statements, self-scored and uncalibrated. It is the entry point for someone who has not been in a room like this one. It is not your rescore tool: you have been calibrated, and the Field Kit is built to hold that standard.

FREE · FOR SOMEONE YOU WOULD SEND IT TO

Next thirty days. One line a week on page 23. You will get one short set of questions on day thirty, and a rescore reminder on day ninety.

You have read your position. The move is the next conversation.



Applying the read

Three applications of the same two axes. Take-home, not new steps in the session.



PROMOTION CHECK

A promotion can increase responsibility, visibility and dependence while reducing formation.

PROMPT

Score the work, not the title. Did the promotion increase the unfamiliar problems you solve, or mainly increase responsibility for work you already understand?

EVIDENCE AND LEGIBILITY

Legibility is not bragging. It is evidence translated into language another context can understand.

PROMPT

Name the problem, the outcome, and the capability the work formed. Remove adjectives about yourself.

AI AND COMPOUNDING

Where AI makes routine output easier to reproduce, your position depends more heavily on judgment, learning velocity, and capability that travels across unfamiliar problems.

PROMPT

Which part of your output is becoming easier to reproduce, and which part of your work is deepening judgment another context would value?

These are applications of Density and Optionality. They are not new parts of the instrument.



Position Exposure Signals

Questions to investigate, not predictions.



CURRENT ROLE

- Is the mandate being absorbed, narrowed, duplicated, or repeatedly redefined?
- Does the position depend on one sponsor?
- Is most of the value legible only inside one context?
- Is the work becoming less formative while expectations remain high?
- Is the organisation redesigning the work without a clear future role for the capability?

A ROLE OR ORGANISATION YOU ARE CONSIDERING

- Why is the role open?
- What work has been added, removed, or consolidated in the past year?
- Who can distinguish excellent work from adequate work?
- Where have people in this role moved next?
- How is AI changing the actual work?

These signals do not predict a layoff. They identify questions that should be answered before you treat a position as secure.

Take-home. Not a step in the two-hour session.